

VINAY NAIR

Lead Platform Engineer · SRE Architect · Cloud & AI Infrastructure

Leads by example — common sense with framework, never framework over common sense.

Amsterdam, NL · Dutch national · EU citizen
+31 6 20391314 · risingvinay@gmail.com
[linkedin.com/in/vinaynair-sre](https://www.linkedin.com/in/vinaynair-sre)
vinay.vawsome.com

Platform engineer, SRE, and hands-on architect with **16 years** of experience — from physical SAN/NAS and Unix at petabyte scale to AI/ML infrastructure and cloud platforms serving hundreds of teams. **Main architect for all AWS landing zone aspects at Shell** and builder of its Enterprise Cloud Platform from the ground up; led cost optimisation returning **€13M in a year** and cut deployment cycles from weeks to minutes across **600+ AWS accounts**. Equally at home as IC, tech lead, product owner, SRE coach, and agile transformer — a leader people follow, who authors half the team's commits while leading it. Currently building **autonomous multi-agent AI systems in production** (AWS Bedrock, AgentCore, Strands SDK).

€13M VERIFIED CLOUD SAVINGS IN 12 MONTHS	600+ AWS ACCOUNTS, LANDING ZONE ARCHITECT	1wk→20m DEPLOYMENT CYCLE AFTER CI/CD OVERHAUL	100s OF LAMBDA S WRITTEN & SHIPPED	25 ENGINEERS TURNED INTO ONE SRE TEAM	26 EKS/AKS CLUSTERS, ONE OBSERVABILITY PANE
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CORE SKILLS / EXPERT MARKED IN AMBER

AWS ·Expert — landing zones (specialty), Control Tower, EKS, Bedrock, SageMaker, Lambda, SSM, Step Functions, TGW, Config, GuardDuty

Kubernetes ·CKA + CKAD certified — EKS, AKS, ROSA, OpenShift, Helm, ArgoCD, Karpenter

Languages ·Python (primary, strong developer), Bash, PowerShell, AWK, HCL, YAML, JavaScript, Perl, Golang (exposure)

Azure ·AKS, Azure ML, AI Foundry, Azure DevOps — plus GCP

Security / FinOps ·Security Hub, GuardDuty, WAF/Shield, Aqua CSPM, WIZ, Vault, CIS L2/3, NIST, Well-Architected, RI/SP optimisation

Leadership ·Leads by example — Product Owner, SRE coaching, Staff SRE mentoring, HLD/LLD design, stakeholder & resource management

AI / ML / Agents ·Multi-agent AI in production — Bedrock, AgentCore, Strands SDK, SageMaker, Azure ML, AI Foundry, Copilot

IaC / Automation ·Terraform (Enterprise + Cloud), StackSets, AVM, Ansible, Packer, AWS CDK, Python frameworks

CI/CD ·GitHub Actions, Jenkins on K8s, Concourse, Azure DevOps, Sonar, Checkov, Copilot PR analysis

Observability ·Prometheus, Grafana, Thanos, Dynatrace, ELK, CloudWatch, Datadog, DTrace

Infrastructure ·Linux, Solaris, AIX, SAN/NAS (EMC, VMAX, NetApp, ZFS), TSM, VMware, networking

Agile at Scale ·SAFe strong practitioner — PI planning, ART coordination, Scrum, agile transformation, logical reasoning first

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Lead SRE, Architect & Mentor — AWS Enterprise Cloud Platform Sep 2024 – Present
Shell · The Hague, Netherlands

- Lead a 12-person DevOps team running Shell's AWS Enterprise Cloud Platform across **600+ business-critical accounts**; author roughly half the team's commits while leading it
- Cut deployment cycle from **1 week to 20 minutes** — touchless change management, automated release notes, auto-tagging, Sonar, Checkov, Copilot PR analysis
- Designed complex SSM Automation for agent installation and EC2 domain-join (multi-Lambda, SSM documents); overhauled provisioning and patching across the estate
- Led **StackSet-to-Terraform migration** across 600+ accounts at 1,000+ resources per account; implemented AWS Backup with enterprise-scale exception handling
- Authored the **Shell AWS One Pager** — adopted enterprise-wide as the definitive AWS onboarding and policy guide
- Primary mentor to Staff Lead SREs on architecture (HLD/LLD), CIS L2/3, NIST, and Well-Architected standards; led OpenShift/ROSA PoC for a 10,000+ VM migration off VMware
- Building **autonomous multi-agent AI systems** in production with AWS Bedrock, AgentCore, and Strands SDK

Lead SRE & Product Owner — FinOps / Cloud Cost Optimisation (CoCo)

Aug 2023 – Sep 2024

Shell · The Hague, Netherlands

- Appointed to pioneer Shell's cloud cost optimisation programme; delivered **€13M in verified savings within 12 months** across AWS and Azure
- RI/Savings Plans strategy, automated non-prod enforcement, orphaned AMI/snapshot/disk cleanup, disk tier migrations, idle RDS shutdowns, Trusted Advisor automation
- Built gamified PowerBI dashboards that turned savings into healthy competition and executive-level accountability across business units

Product Owner & SRE Coach — AWS Platform Team

Aug 2022 – Jul 2023

Shell · Amsterdam, Netherlands

- **Main architect for Shell's AWS landing zone** — AVM, StackSets, and Control Tower implementation across 600+ business-critical accounts
- Turned a newly merged, dysfunctional team of 25 engineers (5 dev, 20 ops) into a high-performing SRE team — SRE culture, Scrum, shared ownership, cross-skill upskilling
- Built fully touchless ServiceNow workflows: account onboarding/update/decom, IAM creation, image allowlisting
- Member of the **Technical Review Board (TRB)** ruling on exceptions; weekly cadence with AWS TAMs

Lead SRE — Data Science & Observability

Sep 2021 – Jul 2022

Shell · Amsterdam, Netherlands

- **Pioneered MLOps at Shell** — first engineer to ship SageMaker and Azure ML as centralised, enterprise-wide shared services
- Established centralised observability for **26 EKS/AKS clusters** (Prometheus, Grafana, Thanos); deployed Aqua CSPM and initiated WIZ migration
- Implemented Dremio data virtualisation with custom Terraform-style provisioning automation built in Python

Cloud DevOps Engineer

Sep 2020 – Sep 2021

Nationale-Nederlanden · The Hague, Netherlands

- Core member of the AWS Landing Zone team provisioning **500+ accounts**; overhauled the CI/CD system end to end
- Designed Transit Gateway with Direct Connect, egress firewall automation, DNS forwarders, and cross-account SSO
- Implemented the enterprise security framework: Config Rules, Security Hub, GuardDuty, Shield, WAF

Lead SRE — Be.Agile Platform (AWS + Azure)

Jun 2019 – Aug 2020

Shell · Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Led the CI/CD team merging Shell's two developer platforms (AWS + Azure) into one serving **400+ developers**
- Architected cross-cloud CI/CD enabling deployments from AWS into Azure; integrated Vault and Terraform Enterprise; built automated untagged-resource cleanup and non-prod sleep cycles

Site Reliability Engineer — Subsurface Data Universe (SDU)

May 2017 – May 2019

Shell · Bengaluru, India

- Core engineer on Shell's pioneering cloud-native programme for **200+ petroleum data scientists** on AWS
- Drove IaC from day one with Terraform and Packer — blank AWS account to Kubernetes; managed **600+ Lambdas** and multi-region K8s workloads with Jenkins-on-K8s CI/CD

EARLIER CAREER

Duty Manager — Unix / Storage / Cloud Infrastructure, Oracle India · Sep 2014 – Apr 2017

Managed 900+ NAS filers and petabytes of data across Oracle's global storage estate; ZFS replication automation, SAN performance optimisation, DTrace-based NAS troubleshooting; shift lead for incident response and change management.

Consultant → Team Lead & Resource Manager — Unix / Storage, HCL Technologies · Sep 2008 – Sep 2014

Progressed from consultant to Team Lead and Resource Manager in four years, managing 10+ engineers. Solaris, AIX, Linux; EMC Clarion, VMAX, NetApp NAS, IBM TSM; Broadcom SAN switches and FC fabrics for enterprise clients.

CERTIFICATIONS, EDUCATION & RIGHT TO WORK

Certifications: Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA), 2023 · Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD), 2023 · Sun Certified Solaris Administrator 1 & 2

Education: B.Tech — Electrical, Electronics & Communications Engineering, University of Calicut, India (2004–2008)

Languages: English, Hindi, Malayalam, Tamil (excellent) · Dutch (conversational) · French (basic)

Right to work: Dutch national — unrestricted EU/NL · UAE/Gulf visa-eligible · open to relocation